

NIRMAAN MODEL UNITED NATIONS 2026

UNCSW

AGENDA:

Deliberation on the role of AI and data economies in reinforcing modern forms of patriarchy and control over women's body.

1. COMMITTEE OVERVIEW

The UN Commission on the Status of Women (UNCSW), established in 1946, is the principal global intergovernmental body dedicated to gender equality and the empowerment of women. It is a functional commission of ECOSOC and meets annually at UN HQ in New York.

The Commission's mandate includes preparing recommendations on promoting women's rights in political, economic, civil, social, and educational fields, and making recommendations on urgent problems requiring immediate attention in the field of women's rights.

2. UNDERSTANDING THE AGENDA

This agenda examines how artificial intelligence systems and the data economy perpetuate and reinforce patriarchal structures. Key dimensions include:

ALGORITHMIC BIAS

- AI hiring tools have shown discrimination against women (e.g., Amazon's AI recruiting tool, scrapped in 2018, penalized resumes containing the word "women's")
- Credit-scoring algorithms reflect historical lending biases that disadvantaged women
- Healthcare AI trained on male-dominated datasets leads to misdiagnosis in women
- Facial recognition systems show higher error rates for women, especially women of colour

DATA ECONOMIES AND SURVEILLANCE

- Fertility tracking apps (Flo, Clue) share intimate health data with third parties including advertisers and, in some jurisdictions, law enforcement
- Post-Dobbs (USA), menstrual tracking data has been subpoenaed in criminal investigations
- Deepfake pornography: 96% of deepfakes online are non-consensual intimate imagery of women (Deeptrace, 2019)
- "Revenge porn" and image-based sexual abuse facilitated by AI generation tools

DIGITAL PATRIARCHY

- Algorithmic content curation reinforces gender stereotypes in advertising and media consumption
- Online harassment: Women receive 27x more abusive content than men on social media platforms (Amnesty International)
- AI chatbots and virtual assistants (Siri, Alexa) originally designed with female voices reinforcing servility stereotypes
- UNESCO report "I'd Blush If I Could" (2019) highlighted how female-gendered AI assistants normalize subservience

3. KEY INTERNATIONAL FRAMEWORKS

- Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW), 1979
- Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action (1995) · 12 critical areas of concern
- CSW67 Agreed Conclusions (2023): "Innovation and technological change, and education in the digital age for achieving gender equality"
- UN General Assembly Resolution 78/265 on AI governance (2024)
- EU AI Act (2024) · first comprehensive AI regulation, includes provisions on bias testing
- UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of AI (2021)
- Council of Europe Convention on AI, Human Rights, Democracy, and Rule of Law (2024)

4. COUNTRY POSITIONS TO RESEARCH

PROGRESSIVE BLOC:

- EU nations · Strong regulatory approach (EU AI Act mandates algorithmic audits for bias)
- Nordic countries · Leaders in gender-inclusive tech policy
- Canada · Feminist Digital Policy, Algorithmic Impact Assessment tool

MODERATE POSITIONS:

- India · National AI Strategy mentions inclusivity but limited gender-specific provisions
- Brazil · AI Bill under consideration with anti-discrimination clauses
- South Africa · Focus on digital inclusion for women in developing contexts

CONSERVATIVE/OPPOSING VIEWS:

- USA · Market-driven approach, limited federal AI regulation
- China · Extensive AI deployment with state surveillance concerns
- Saudi Arabia/Gulf states · Varying positions on women's digital rights

GLOBAL SOUTH PERSPECTIVE:

- Digital divide: Only 63% of women globally use the internet vs. 69% of men (ITU, 2023)
- Women in Sub-Saharan Africa are 36% less likely to use mobile internet than men

5. POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

Your position paper (1-2 pages) should include:

1. HEADER: Country name, committee, delegate name, school
2. COUNTRY'S POSITION: Your nation's stance on AI regulation and gender
3. PAST ACTIONS: What your country has done domestically and internationally
4. PROPOSED SOLUTIONS: 3-5 actionable clauses for a draft resolution

SAMPLE CLAUSES TO CONSIDER:

- Mandatory algorithmic impact assessments with gender-disaggregated data
- International framework for criminalizing AI-generated non-consensual intimate imagery
- Funding for women's digital literacy and STEM education in developing nations
- Gender parity requirements in AI development teams
- Establishment of a UN Special Rapporteur on AI and Gender Equality

6. RECOMMENDED READINGS

ESSENTIAL:

- Safiya Umoja Noble, "Algorithms of Oppression" (2018)
- Caroline Criado Perez, "Invisible Women: Data Bias in a World Designed for Men" (2019)
- UNESCO, "I'd Blush If I Could: Closing Gender Divides in Digital Skills" (2019)
- UN Women, CSW67 Expert Group Meeting Report (2023)

SUPPLEMENTARY:

- Access Now, "Human Rights in the Age of AI" (2018)
- World Economic Forum, "Global Gender Gap Report 2024"
- Amnesty International, "Toxic Twitter" Research (2018)
- OHCHR, "The Right to Privacy in the Digital Age" reports